

Validation Source Reliability Standard

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Canonical Definition

Validation Source Reliability Standard (VSRS) defines the governance conditions under which sources providing, generating, transmitting, recording, transforming, interpreting, or maintaining Validation Evidence are identified, attributable, provenance-aware, independence-assessed, integrity-aware, competence-aware, conflict-aware, and sufficiently reliable for their assigned role within a governed validation process.

Canonical Definition Extension

Evidence does not exist independently of origin.

It is generated, observed, recorded, measured, transmitted, transformed, interpreted, stored, or supplied by one or more sources.

A piece of evidence may be highly relevant, applicable, comprehensive, and adequate while the reliability of the source behind that evidence remains uncertain.

VALIDOS® therefore separates:

Evidence Fitness

from:

Source Reliability

Validation Source Reliability Standard governs the second question.

It establishes the conditions necessary to determine:

- where Validation Evidence originated,
- which source produced or supplied it,
- whether the source can be sufficiently identified,
- whether attribution can be established,
- whether provenance is sufficiently reconstructable,
- whether the source possesses the required competence or capability,
- whether relevant independence exists,
- whether conflicts of interest are visible,
- whether the evidence passed through intermediaries,
- whether material transformations occurred,
- whether source integrity conditions are known,
- whether corroboration is required,
- whether source reliability has materially changed,
- and whether the source can legitimately support the evidentiary role assigned to it.

VSRS does not determine whether evidence is relevant or adequate.

It does not determine whether the Validation Object is valid.

It determines whether the **source relationship behind Validation Evidence is sufficiently reliable for governed validation use.**

Core Question

Can the source behind Validation Evidence be sufficiently identified, traced, assessed, and relied upon for the validation role assigned to it?

Purpose

The purpose of Validation Source Reliability Standard is to prevent validation confidence from being derived from evidence whose source basis is unknown, insufficiently attributable, materially conflicted, methodologically incapable, excessively dependent, provenance-deficient, or otherwise unreliable.

The standard prevents validation from silently treating:

- anonymous origin as established origin,
- publication as reliability,
- institutional authority as universal competence,
- repetition as independence,
- multiple intermediaries as multiple independent sources,
- source popularity as methodological credibility,
- source confidence as evidence quality,
- and source reputation as permanent reliability.

VSRS creates a governed source-reliability layer between qualified evidence and subsequent validation execution.

Governance Objective

VSRS establishes a governed Validation Source Reliability Framework capable of determining whether sources behind Validation Evidence possess sufficient reliability for their assigned validation roles.

The standard seeks to ensure that:

- source identity is sufficiently established,
 - source attribution is traceable,
 - provenance is reconstructable,
 - source roles are explicit,
 - material intermediaries are visible,
 - material transformations are traceable,
 - competence is proportionate to the source role,
 - independence is assessed where required,
 - conflicts of interest remain visible,
 - source dependencies are identifiable,
 - corroboration requirements can be established,
 - source reliability conditions remain bounded,
 - reliability change can be detected,
 - and source reliability can be formally determined.
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Operational Role

Validation Source Reliability Standard serves as the **source-qualification stage of the VALIDOS® validation lifecycle.**

The preceding architecture establishes:

**Validation Object → Validation Purpose & Scope → Validation Criteria
→ Validation Method → Validation Evidence Fitness**

VSRS then asks:

Can the sources underlying that qualified evidence basis be sufficiently relied upon?

Its structural progression is:

**Qualified Validation Evidence → Source Identification → Source Provenance → Source Capability → Independence & Conflict Assessment
→ Source Reliability Determination → Reliability-Qualified Evidence Basis**

The resulting source-qualified evidence basis can then progress into Validation Execution governance.

Governance Scope

Validation Source Reliability Standard governs:

- validation-source identification,
- source attribution,
- source origin,
- source provenance,
- source lineage,
- source roles,
- source capability,
- source competence,
- source authority where relevant,
- source independence,
- source dependence,
- conflicts of interest,
- source incentives,
- source intermediaries,
- evidence transformations,
- source integrity conditions,
- source corroboration,
- source convergence,
- source reliability limitations,
- source reliability uncertainty,
- source reliability status,
- source reliability change,
- source reliability expiration,
- source reliability reassessment,
- and source-reliability traceability.

Validation Source

For the purposes of VALIDOS®, a Validation Source is any identifiable entity, system, process, instrument, repository, person, organization, model, sensor, database, document origin, operational environment, or other origin capable of materially contributing Validation Evidence.

A source may:

- generate evidence,
- observe evidence,
- record evidence,
- measure evidence,
- transform evidence,
- transmit evidence,
- interpret evidence,
- aggregate evidence,
- preserve evidence,
- or provide evidence.

Different source roles may require different reliability conditions.

Source Identity

Source reliability cannot be meaningfully governed where the relevant source cannot be sufficiently distinguished.

Source identity may require identification of:

- source entity,
- source instance,
- system,
- instrument,
- organization,
- individual,
- repository,
- model,
- dataset origin,
- version,
- or another relevant source representation.

The required identity precision should correspond to the validation role and consequence.

Source Attribution

VSRS governs whether Validation Evidence can be sufficiently attributed to the source claimed to have generated, observed, recorded, transmitted, or supplied it.

Attribution may be:

Direct

Derived

Intermediated Aggregated

Uncertain

or:

Unattributed

Attribution status must remain visible where it materially affects source reliability.

Source Provenance

Provenance establishes the history through which evidence reached the validation process.

The governed progression may include:

Origin → Generation → Recording → Transformation → Transmission →

Aggregation → Storage → Retrieval → Validation Use

Not every validation requires complete reconstruction of every technical event.

The required provenance depth must be proportionate to the evidentiary role, Validation Depth, and consequence of reliance.

Source Lineage

Evidence may derive from multiple upstream sources.

A final report, dataset, benchmark, or analytical output may represent a downstream source while depending upon:

- primary observations,
- external datasets,
- prior studies,
- other models,
- third-party measurements,
- or aggregated records.

VSRS requires material upstream dependencies to remain visible where they affect reliability.

Primary and Derived Sources

VALIDOS® distinguishes between:

Primary Source

and:

Derived Source

A Primary Source originates the relevant observation, measurement, record, or event representation.

A Derived Source obtains its evidentiary content through another source or transformation.

Derived evidence is not automatically less reliable.

However, derivation creates additional lineage and transformation conditions that may require governance.

Source Capability

A source must be capable of performing the evidentiary role assigned to it.

Capability may concern:

- measurement capability,
- observation capability,
- technical capability,
- analytical capability,
- domain capability,
- operational access,
- data access,
- or another relevant function.

A source may be highly reputable while lacking capability for a particular evidentiary role.

Source Competence

Where human, institutional, professional, or analytical judgment contributes materially to Validation Evidence, competence may require assessment.

Relevant considerations may include:

- expertise,
- qualification,
- experience,
- methodological understanding,
- domain knowledge,
- or demonstrated capability.

VSRS does not establish universal professional qualification requirements.

It governs whether competence is sufficient for the role assigned within validation.

Source Authority and Source Reliability

Authority may be relevant but is not equivalent to reliability.

VALIDOS® establishes:

Source Authority ≠ Source Reliability

An authoritative institution may be highly reliable within its governed domain while remaining unsuitable for conclusions outside its competence or evidentiary role.

Likewise, a non-authoritative source may provide highly reliable primary evidence.

VSRS therefore evaluates reliability according to function rather than title alone.

Source Independence

Some validation roles require independent evidence.

Independence may concern separation from:

- the Validation Object creator,
- system operator,
- financial beneficiary,
- decision authority,
- evidence generator,
- prior evaluator,
- or another materially interested party.

Independence requirements should be proportionate to Validation Purpose, Depth, and consequence.

Independence Is Not Binary

A source may possess different forms and degrees of independence.

Possible dimensions include:

- organizational independence,
- financial independence,
- methodological independence,
- operational independence,
- informational independence,
- analytical independence,
- and decision independence.

A source should not be classified as simply "independent" without regard to the independence dimension relevant to the validation role.

Source Dependence

Multiple sources may appear independent while relying upon the same upstream origin.

For example:

ten publications may all repeat information from one original dataset.

Counting them as ten independent sources would create false corroboration.

VSRS therefore governs source dependence and shared lineage.

Conflict of Interest

A conflict of interest does not automatically make a source unreliable.

It creates a governance condition.

Material conflicts may include:

- financial interest,
- organizational interest,
- reputational interest,
- operational ownership,
- contractual dependence,
- competitive interest,
- personal interest,
- or another incentive capable of affecting evidentiary behavior.

Conflicts should be identified, assessed, and incorporated into the Source Reliability Determination.

Source Incentives

Source reliability may be affected by incentives even where no formal conflict exists.

Incentives may encourage:

- selective reporting,
- favorable interpretation,
- omission,
- exaggeration,
- under-reporting,
- or evidentiary framing.

VSRS therefore permits incentive analysis where material to validation reliability.

Source Intermediaries

Evidence may pass through intermediaries before reaching validation.

Intermediaries may:

- transmit,
- translate,
- aggregate,
- reformat,
- summarize,
- filter,
- classify,

- or transform evidence.

Each material intermediary may create additional provenance and reliability conditions.

Evidence Transformation

Transformation can change evidentiary meaning.

Examples include:

- aggregation,
- normalization,
- translation,
- compression,
- filtering,
- statistical processing,
- model interpretation,
- summarization,
- anonymization,
- or format conversion.

VSRS governs whether material transformations are sufficiently identifiable and traceable.

It does not determine whether the resulting evidence is adequate; that remains within VEFS.

Source Integrity Conditions

VSRS may consume relevant integrity information concerning whether a source, record, system, instrument, or evidentiary pathway has remained protected against material alteration, corruption, substitution, or loss.

Where integrity governance is required, **INTEGROS®** may provide complementary integrity conditions.

VSRS uses such information only insofar as it affects source reliability within validation.

Source Corroboration

Some source roles may require corroboration.

Corroboration asks whether materially independent sources support compatible evidentiary conclusions.

VSRS distinguishes genuine corroboration from repetition.

Repeated information from one upstream source does not constitute

independent corroboration.

Source Convergence

Where multiple sufficiently independent sources converge upon compatible evidence, source reliability confidence may increase.

However, convergence must not automatically override:

- shared bias,
- shared methodology,
- shared datasets,
- shared incentives,
- or common upstream dependencies.

VSRS therefore requires convergence to remain lineage-aware.

Source Reliability Limitations

A source may be reliable within defined boundaries.

For example:

- reliable for raw measurement but not interpretation,
- reliable for one jurisdiction but not another,
- reliable for one operating environment,
- reliable for one data type,
- or reliable only within a defined period.

Source Reliability Determinations must preserve these boundaries.

Source Reliability Uncertainty

Where source identity, provenance, capability, independence, or another material condition cannot be sufficiently established, VSRS preserves uncertainty.

Possible outcomes should not be forced into a binary trusted/untrusted classification.

Uncertainty itself is a governed source condition.

Source Reliability Status

VSRS may establish conditions such as:

Source Reliable

The source is sufficiently reliable for the defined validation role.

Source Conditionally Reliable

The source may support validation only within explicit conditions, limitations, or restrictions.

Source Reliability Undetermined

Available information is insufficient to establish a defensible reliability determination.

Source Reliability Insufficient

Material source-reliability requirements remain unresolved.

Source Unreliable

The source cannot legitimately perform the proposed validation role.

These states apply to the source-role relationship.

They do not represent Evidence Fitness or the Validation State of the Validation Object.

Source Reliability Is Role-Specific

VALIDOS® establishes:

A source is not universally reliable or unreliable.

The same source may be:

Reliable for direct measurement,

Conditionally Reliable for interpretation,

and:

Unreliable for conclusions outside its capability.

Reliability must therefore remain connected to the exact evidentiary role assigned to the source.

Source Reliability and Evidence Fitness

VALIDOS® maintains the architectural separation:

Evidence Fitness asks:

Is the evidence fit for the validation question?

Source Reliability asks:

Can the source behind that evidence be sufficiently relied upon for its assigned role?

Neither condition substitutes for the other.

Possible combinations include:

Fit Evidence + Reliable Source

Fit Evidence + Unreliable Source

Unfit Evidence + Reliable Source

Unfit Evidence + Unreliable Source

Only by governing both dimensions can VALIDOS® distinguish evidentiary quality from source trustworthiness.

Source Reliability and Truth

A reliable source does not automatically make every statement true.

VALIDOS® establishes:

Reliable Source ≠ True Claim

Source reliability concerns the credibility of the source relationship within validation.

Truth-oriented assessment remains a separate methodological question.

Source Reliability and Execution

VSRS does not determine whether the approved validation methodology was correctly executed.

A reliable source can still be used incorrectly.

An unreliable source can also be correctly processed while producing a weak validation basis.

Execution governance therefore remains a subsequent independent VALIDOS® responsibility.

Source Reliability Change

Source reliability may change because of:

- source modification,
 - ownership change,
 - capability change,
 - newly discovered conflicts,
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- provenance discovery,
- compromised systems,
- altered incentives,
- new upstream dependencies,
- changed methodology,
- or new reliability evidence.

Material change may require reassessment.

Source Reliability Expiration

A Source Reliability Determination may be time-bounded.

Expiration may be appropriate where reliability depends upon:

- certification periods,
- calibration,
- organizational conditions,
- system versions,
- personnel qualifications,
- current independence,
- or another time-sensitive condition.

Expiration does not mean the source becomes unreliable automatically.

It means the previous determination can no longer be assumed current without reassessment.

Source Reliability Traceability

Source Reliability should remain traceable to:

- Validation Evidence,
- source identity,
- source role,
- provenance,
- lineage,
- capability,
- competence where applicable,
- independence,
- dependencies,
- conflicts,
- transformations,
- corroboration,
- limitations,
- uncertainty,
- reliability status,
- and subsequent validation use.

This creates reconstructable source governance across the VALIDOS® lifecycle.

Governance Boundary

Validation Source Reliability Standard begins when qualified Validation Evidence possesses identifiable or potentially identifiable sources requiring reliability assessment.

It ends when the material source relationships behind the evidence basis have been sufficiently identified, traced, assessed, bounded, and assigned a Source Reliability status for their intended validation roles.

VSRS does not determine:

- Validation Object identity,
- Validation Purpose or Scope,
- Validation Criteria,
- Validation Method suitability,
- Evidence Relevance,
- Evidence Applicability,
- Evidence Coverage,
- Evidence Adequacy,
- Validation Execution conformity,
- final Validation Determination,
- Validation State,
- reliance authorization,
- or revalidation requirements.

These responsibilities belong to other VALIDOS® Parent Standards.

Minimum Governance Requirements

A conforming implementation of VSRS should establish:

- 1. identifiable validation-source relationships,
- 2. sufficient source attribution,
- 3. relevant source provenance and lineage,
- 4. material source roles,
- 5. source capability for the assigned role,
- 6. competence where materially required,
- 7. independence assessment where applicable,
- 8. source-dependence visibility,
- 9. material conflict-of-interest visibility,

10. material intermediary and transformation visibility, 11. corroboration conditions where required, 12. source-reliability limitations and uncertainty, 13. a Source Reliability Determination, 14. and sufficient lifecycle traceability.

Governance Outputs

VSRS may produce:

- Validation Source Register,
- Source Identity Record,
- Source Attribution Record,
- Source Provenance Record,
- Source Lineage Map,
- Source Role Record,
- Source Capability Assessment,
- Source Competence Assessment,
- Source Independence Assessment,
- Source Dependence Map,
- Conflict-of-Interest Record,
- Source Incentive Record,
- Evidence Transformation Record,
- Source Corroboration Assessment,
- Source Reliability Limitation Record,
- Source Reliability Determination,
- Source Reliability Change Record,
- Source Reliability Reassessment Trigger,
- and Reliability-Qualified Evidence Basis.

Operational Applications

Validation Source Reliability Standard may be applied across:

- artificial intelligence,
- machine learning,
- autonomous systems,
- scientific evidence,
- datasets,
- benchmark results,
- AI-generated information,
- predictions,
- simulations,
- expert assessments,
- sensor systems,
- operational records,
- enterprise analytics,
- financial services,
- healthcare,
- industrial operations,
- regulatory compliance,
- critical infrastructure,
- digital assets,
- digital identities,
- public-sector decision systems,
- and any governed environment requiring source-aware validation.

Relationship to Other OOF Architectures

Validation Source Reliability Standard interoperates with:

- **GOA™**
- **OBIDENTITY®**
- **INTEGROS®**
- **ORA™**
- **AGA™**
- **AIG®**
- **CLIA®**
- **MGIA™**
- **ASGA™**
- **RIS™**

by providing the canonical validation-governance methodology for assessing whether sources underlying Validation Evidence can be sufficiently relied upon for their assigned validation roles.

OBIDENTITY® may provide complementary origin, identity, ownership, provenance, and continuity information.

INTEGROS® may provide complementary integrity conditions.

AGA™ may provide complementary accountability relationships.

ORA™ may provide complementary operational-reality information.

VSRS does not duplicate these architectures.

It consumes relevant governed information where necessary and determines what that information means specifically for **source reliability within validation**.

Foundational Principle

Evidence cannot become more trustworthy merely because its source remains unquestioned.

Canonical Closing Statement

Validation Source Reliability Standard establishes the source-qualification layer of VALIDOS® — Validation Governance Architecture. By governing source identity, attribution, provenance, lineage, capability, competence, independence, dependence, conflicts, incentives, intermediaries, transformations, corroboration, convergence, limitations, uncertainty, change,

expiration, and traceability, VSRS ensures that validation does not rely upon evidence without also governing the reliability of the sources and source relationships from which that evidence derives.

Validation Source Reliability Standard

Architecture: VALIDOS® — Validation Governance Architecture

Category: AI & Interpretation · **Subcategory:** Validation Governance

Canonical Definition: Validation Source Reliability Standard (VSRS)

defines the governance conditions under which sources providing, generating, transmitting, recording, transforming, interpreting, or maintaining Validation Evidence are identified, attributable, provenance-aware, independence-assessed, integrity-aware, competence-aware, conflict-aware, and sufficiently reliable for their assigned role within a governed validation process.

Governed Space: Validation Source Reliability

Evidence cannot become more trustworthy merely because its source remains unquestioned.

→ [View Standard](#)

Module Architecture

→ [Validation Source Identity & Attribution Module \(VSIAM\)](#)

→ [Validation Source Provenance & Lineage Module \(VSPLM\)](#)

→ [Validation Source Capability & Competence Module \(VSCCM\)](#)

→ [Validation Source Independence & Conflict Module \(VSICM\)](#)

→ [Validation Source Reliability Determination Module \(VSRDM\)](#)

Parent Resources

→ [VALIDOS® Architecture Map](#)

→ [VALIDOS® Complete Standards & Modules Index](#)

Standards Compatibility

→ [Validation Evidence Fitness Standard](#)

Operational compatibility within the governed validation lifecycle.

→ [Validation Execution Standard](#)

Operational compatibility within the governed validation lifecycle.

→ [Validation Determination Standard](#)

Operational compatibility within the governed validation lifecycle.

Related Documents

→ [About Validation Source Reliability Standard](#)

→ [VALIDOS® Validation Governance Architecture — Validation Governance Layer](#)

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Canonical Source

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